iron ore and soybeans, was that it also shifted Brazil's export profile (which by 2000 prominently featured such items as automobile parts and commuter aircraft) back to that of a primary products exporter. This development was deeply troubling to economists across Brazil's political spectrum. It was also noticed that Chinese citizens, possibly employing government funds, were purchasing large tracts of agricultural land, presumably to ensure supply security and lower prices for themselves. Brazil passed new legislation limiting foreign land ownership in 2010 and tightened it in 2013.[253]

However, as Brazil's economy entered into decline from late 2012, and especially after its political corruption crisis escalated in 2014, President Rousseff began looking to the Chinese, with their still-ample foreign currency reserves, less as equal partners and more as possible saviors. Thus, in 2009, Petrobras, having recently announced unexpectedly large new deepwater petroleum reserves off the coast of Rio de Janeiro, was the darling of lenders everywhere, receiving new commitments for $6.5 billion from private international consortia, $2 billion from the Export-Import Bank of the United States, and $12.5 billion from Brazil's own BNDES. The addition of a $10 billion loan from the CDB was almost seen as a Brazilian favor to China, and Brazil demurred on taking out further RMB-denominated loans.[254] President da Silva and Chinese President Hu Jintao, meeting in Beijing, also agreed to begin to study the possibilities for trade invoiced in local currencies and joint investment in biofuels in Africa (a Brazilian enthusiasm), while China promised to remove import restrictions affecting Brazilian poultry and beef. An official from the Brazilian Central Bank, however, emphasized that the talks were not about a "currency swap," as would have been the case if Brazil were unable to access hard currency, like its Southern neighbor, Argentina, but rather would constitute links between equals to stimulate trade.[255] President da Silva told the press, "Brazil isn't afraid of China, and China isn't afraid of Brazil."[256]

By 2013, the government's relations with China had shifted away from self-congratulatory rhetoric and toward obvious hopes that China's financial resources could help to rescue Brazil. In 2014 and early 2015, Brazil's developmentalist President Rousseff was obliged to go against her instincts and announce a series of large privatizations, in which concessions to run various essential facilities, particularly in transportation, would be